

NORTHBRIDGE DYNAMICS PVT. LTD.

Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) Policy

Document detail	Information
Document ID	HR-05
Version	3.0
Effective date	1 January 2026
Policy owner	Internal Committee (ICC)
Approved by	Managing Director
Applies to	All employees, interns, trainees, contract staff, consultants and visitors, at the office, at client sites, at Company events, during travel and online

1. Policy Statement

Northbridge Dynamics has zero tolerance for sexual harassment. This policy follows the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013. As a Company commitment, the same complaint and inquiry process is available to employees of any gender.

2. What is Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment is any unwelcome act or behaviour of a sexual nature, whether direct or implied, including:

- Physical contact or advances, or touching in an unwelcome manner.
- A demand or request for sexual favours.
- Sexually coloured remarks, jokes or comments about a person's body.
- Showing pornography or sharing sexual images, messages or videos.
- Any other unwelcome physical, verbal or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature, including online and through messaging apps.
- Promising, threatening or implying preferential or detrimental treatment connected to sexual conduct.

3. Internal Committee (ICC)

- The Company has an Internal Committee at the Gurugram head office and local committees for Pune and Bengaluru.
- The committee has a Presiding Officer (a senior woman employee), at least 2 employee members committed to the cause of women or with legal or social-work experience, and 1 external member from an NGO or association working for women. At least half the members are women.
- The names and contact details of ICC members are on the portal and on office notice boards. Contact: icc@northbridge.example.

4. How to Make a Complaint

- Submit a written complaint to the ICC, with any evidence or witness names, **within 3 months** of the incident (or of the last incident in a series). The ICC can extend this by another 3 months if it is satisfied that there were valid reasons for delay.
- If you cannot write the complaint, an ICC member will help you put it in writing.

- If the complainant is unable to complain because of a physical or mental incapacity, or has died, a legal heir or a person authorised by them can complain.
- Do not wait to be sure. If you are unsure whether something qualifies, you can still speak to the ICC in confidence.

Important: complaints of sexual harassment are not handled by the HR helpdesk chatbot. If a person asks the chatbot about a harassment incident, the chatbot only shares this process and the ICC contact, and does not ask for details of the incident.

5. Inquiry Process

Stage	What happens	Timeline
Receipt	ICC acknowledges the complaint and sends a copy to the respondent.	Within 7 days
Conciliation (optional)	At the written request of the complainant, the ICC tries to settle the matter. No monetary settlement is allowed as the basis of conciliation.	Before inquiry starts
Respondent reply	The respondent submits a reply with documents and witness names.	Within 10 days of receiving the copy
Inquiry	Both sides are heard, and evidence and witnesses are examined, following natural justice.	Completed within 90 days
Report	ICC gives its findings and recommendations to the Company and to both parties.	Within 10 days of completing the inquiry
Action	The Company acts on the recommendations.	Within 60 days of the report

6. Interim Relief

During the inquiry, at the written request of the complainant, the ICC can recommend: transfer of the complainant or respondent to another team or location, up to 3 months of additional paid leave for the complainant, restraining the respondent from reporting on or evaluating the complainant's work, or any other relief the ICC considers appropriate.

7. Outcomes

- If the allegation is proved, action can include a written warning, withholding of increment or promotion, suspension, termination, and mandatory counselling, as recommended by the ICC. Where the law requires, the matter is also reported to the police.
- If the allegation is not proved, no action is taken against the respondent.
- If a complaint is found to be made with malicious intent, or evidence is found to be false, action can be taken against the person who complained. A complaint that is simply not proved is not malicious.
- Either party can appeal as per the Act within 90 days.

8. Confidentiality and Non-Retaliation

- The identity of the complainant, respondent and witnesses, and the details of the inquiry, are strictly confidential and cannot be published or shared, including under the Right to Information Act.

- Retaliation of any kind against a person who complains or supports a complaint is gross misconduct.

9. Awareness and Reporting

- All employees must complete POSH awareness training within 30 days of joining and every year after that.
- The ICC prepares an annual report on the number of complaints received and resolved, which is shared with the authorities as required by law.

Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of change
3.0	1 January 2026	Annual review and update. Fictional policy created for demonstration of the HR helpdesk chatbot.